DSEH004 Performance Management and Employee Engagement

Week 10 | Lecture 2 | Unit IV

Integrating Learning with Performance

Transfer of training, the 70-20-10 claim, and building capability that shows up at work

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Commit before theory

A company says 70 percent of learning comes from experience, 20 percent from others and 10 percent from courses, so it cuts training. Is this sound?

A

Yes, the ratio is well established

B

The ratio is a heuristic with little empirical support

C

Courses are useless anyway

D

Only if experience is structured

Baldwin and Ford: the transfer problem

Trainee characteristics

Ability, personality, motivation

Training design

Principles of learning, sequencing, content

Work environment

Support and opportunity to use the skill

Transfer

Generalization and maintenance on the job

Learning in the classroom is not the goal; use at work over time is. Blume et al. (2010) confirmed the work environment matters

Kirkpatrick's four levels, and their limits

Level	Question	Caution
Reaction	Did people like it?	Alliger et al. (1997): reactions relate weakly to learning and behavior
Learning	Did they gain knowledge or skill?	Test immediately and after a delay
Behavior	Do they use it at work?	Depends on work environment and manager
Results	Did the business outcome change?	Hardest to attribute; needs comparison groups

The 70-20-10 claim

Origins

- Grew from interviews on how executives learned (McCall, Lombardo and Morrison, 1988)
- Useful reminder that experience teaches

vs

The critique

- Clardy (2018): little evidence for the precise ratio
- Used to justify cutting formal learning
- Experience teaches best when structured and reflected on

What builds expertise

1 Deliberate practice

Ericsson et al. (1993): focused practice on weaknesses with feedback

2 But not all

Macnamara et al. (2014): deliberate practice explains only a small share of performance in professions

3 Spacing

Cepeda et al. (2006): spaced practice beats massed practice for retention

Design learning as spaced practice with feedback inside real work, not as a one-time event

Integrating learning with performance management

Diagnose

Check-ins identify one capability gap per person

Plan

Stretch assignment plus a short formal input

Practice

Spaced practice with feedback from manager or peer

Review

Next check-in reviews behavior change, not attendance

Training that did not transfer

Teaching case (Course framing)

A Chandigarh hospital trains 300 nurses in patient communication. Feedback forms rate the course 4.7 out of 5. Six months later, complaint rates are unchanged. Ward managers say there is no time to practice the new approach during busy shifts.

Work it through

1. Which Kirkpatrick levels were measured?
2. Locate the failure in Baldwin and Ford's model
3. Design a spaced practice approach within shifts
4. How would you evaluate results fairly?

Exam-style question

Evaluate the 70-20-10 framework and explain how learning and development should be integrated with performance management to improve transfer. (20 marks)

What a strong answer does

- States the origin and critique accurately
- Applies Baldwin and Ford and Blume et al. to transfer
- Uses Kirkpatrick with Alliger et al.'s caution
- Proposes integration through check-ins, practice and review

Sources (1 of 2)

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